CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

# STUDY MATERIALS - 19

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

## Read the following message.

To: Senior Managers, Prairie West Credit Union
From: Richard Poole, President and CEO
Subject: MEMO – CONFIDENTIAL: Monitoring computer use
Dear Senior Managers,

Like all banks, Prairie West thinks that data security is absolutely necessary. As a result, last month we improved our computer network by dividing it into separate, secure sub-networks for each department. This will ensure that if there is a cyberattack, it will not affect the entire system. We have a very experienced Information Technology (IT) team that knows what to do if a cyberattack happens. However, we will be doing more in the upcoming months.

Studies show that over 64% of employees visit non-work-related websites and over 84% read and send personal emails while they are at work. When employees use our company's computer network for personal activities, they can negatively impact not only their productivity but also their personal security. Visiting certain websites or downloading attachments can lead to identity theft and put our network at risk. Our system could be infected by harmful programs such as spyware and viruses. The creators of these programs would then have access to sensitive information, such as customers' credit card and bank account numbers. As you know, our customers depend on that information not becoming public.

Like many organizations, we block certain websites, and we have rules against personal emailing. However, staff do not always follow these policies, and new websites appear more quickly than we can block them. Therefore, starting next month, we will monitor all employees' internet use. We hope that this will discourage employees from inappropriate online behaviour that puts our company's data at risk.

We know that monitoring employees can lead to low staff morale and feelings of distrust, especially if the company doesn't let the staff know about it first. Therefore, we have decided to inform employees that we will be doing this, even though it would be possible for us to monitor them secretly. Thus, I am asking all senior managers to present the new policy, in detail, to their staff at their next department meeting.

If any of you would like to speak with me about this request, please contact me. As always, I welcome your feedback and suggestions.

Regards,

Richard

## Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. What recently happened at this company?
- ◯ It suffered a cyberattack.
- ◯ It expanded its IT department.
- ◯ It experienced many threats.
- ◯ It created several networks.

2. Why is blocking websites ineffective?
- ◯ The company has too many networks.
- ◯ The computer systems are too old.
- ◯ The internet is growing too quickly.
- ◯ The IT team is too busy.

3. The memo is quite _____
- ◯ formal.
- ◯ casual.
- ◯ entertaining.
- ◯ unfriendly.

4. The writer is concerned that his decision could lead to _____
- ◯ disorganized departments.
- ◯ dissatisfied employees.
- ◯ untrustworthy managers.
- ◯ worried customers.

5. The writer thinks programs to watch employees should be _____
- ◯ avoided.
- ◯ explained.
- ◯ optional.
- ◯ free.

6. What does the writer ask the readers to do?
- ◯ speak to their staff
- ◯ talk to their manager
- ◯ forward this memo to staff
- ◯ attend a meeting with him

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PART 1

## Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Hello Richard,

I'm writing regarding your memo about 7._____ . It's clear from what you've said that our IT department 8._____ , and security is obviously important for our business. I agree with you that some type of monitoring 9._____ , but I'm not sure that you're taking the best approach. As you've mentioned, studies show that many employees are currently 10._____ , and I'm not sure that your solution will change that. Your message suggests that only 11._____. However, I think the problem has other causes and other possible solutions which I encourage you to consider. Perhaps you could meet with all the senior managers to discuss other alternatives.

Best,

Matt Lubin

Senior Manager, Operations

7. ◯ hiring new IT professionals
   ◯ monitoring our staff's internet use
   ◯ updating our virus software
   ◯ protecting our customers' accounts

8. ◯ requires network security training
   ◯ has made many mistakes in the past
   ◯ needs to hire more qualified staff
   ◯ is informed about how to respond

9. ◯ might be a terrible mistake
   ◯ would raise staff morale
   ◯ is likely to gain acceptance
   ◯ is essential in our business

10. ◯ creating personal risks for themselves
    ◯ reducing their personal internet use
    ◯ sharing private customer information
    ◯ improving their productivity online

11. ◯ banks are at risk of information theft
    ◯ personal online activities are a problem
    ◯ professionals are responsible for security
    ◯ staff are trying to harm the network

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PART 2

# Enter to win a FREE bicycle package!

Brought to you by **Valley Bicycles**

Tell us why you love biking for your chance to win a bicycle package which includes your choice of either a Conner 3.0 Mountain Bike or a Conner 2.0 Commuter Road Bike, and a variety of biking accessories including a long-distance backpack, filtered water bottle, and fitness wristband.

Conner 3.0 Mountain Bike

Conner 2.0 Road Bike

**To enter, complete the following steps before June 30.**

1) Sign up for our mailing list to receive exclusive information on new products, in-store promotions, and online offers.
2) Send us an email at **valleybicycles@contestentry.ca** explaining why bicycling is one of your favourite pastimes and what you intend to do if you win. Responses should be a maximum of 500 words.
3) Include a photograph of you participating in a bicycling activity. This could be anything from a photo of you and your family bicycling in the park or even a photo of you mountain biking in the Canadian Rockies! Please ensure that all photos are appropriate for younger viewers.
4) Make sure to include your name, address, and a phone number we can reach you at.

To enter, you must be at least 18 years old. Contest only open to residents of Canada; proof of residency may be requested. Please note that by entering this contest, you give us permission to publish your name, photograph, and responses on our website.

**Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks**

Subject: Contest Entry
To: Valley Bicycles <valleybicycles@contestentry.ca>
From: Mark Timmons <mtimmons@email.com>

Dear Valley Bicycles,

Please enter my name 1._____ . As requested, I have attached a photo of 2._____ . I cycle to work daily on an old Conner bike. I bike all year round, except in heavy snow. I'm not that brave! If I win, I'd choose the mountain bike. With it, I would take a vacation biking through the mountains and along the coastal roads. I'm hoping the 3._____ will include a bicycle tire pump, which would be very useful on such a trip. I really hope I win. I made a bet with my wife that, if I do, she has to come with me on the trip. She said she's not packing her bags any time soon! Could you tell me how the winners are chosen? Is it a random draw or will the best 4._____ be chosen? Also, is it really necessary to 5._____ on your website if I win? I'm quite a private person.

Best,

Mark Timmons

1. ◯ for your bike contest
   ◯ in the lottery draw
   ◯ in your bike race
   ◯ beside the photograph

2. ◯ my family at the Rockies
   ◯ my daughter's new bike
   ◯ me climbing a mountain
   ◯ me biking with a friend

3. ◯ new products
   ◯ biking accessories
   ◯ mountain bike
   ◯ road bike

4. ◯ new product idea
   ◯ written response
   ◯ bicycle review
   ◯ photograph title

5. ◯ print my name
   ◯ publish my email
   ◯ share my phone number
   ◯ give out my address

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PART 2

## Choose the best option.

6. Why does Mark describe his biking experiences?

- ◯ to explain why he deserves a new bike
- ◯ to enter for a discount on the bike
- ◯ to fulfill the contest requirements
- ◯ to describe the photo he sent in

7. Why does Mark want to win?

- ◯ to get a bike for his trip
- ◯ to pay for his bike trip
- ◯ to start biking to work
- ◯ to get his wife a bike

8. How would Mark's wife likely feel about his application?

- ◯ He will definitely win.
- ◯ His picture is unsuitable.
- ◯ He's the best contestant.
- ◯ He's unlikely to win.

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PART 3

## Read the following passage.

**A.** In 1951, a report commissioned by Canada's federal government indicated that professional theatre was moribund, music was present only in churches and schools, and English Canada produced only 14 works of fiction per year. Artists—whether writers, composers, or actors—couldn't make enough money from their art to support themselves. This famous Massey Report recommended that the government create the Canada Council for the Encouragement of the Arts, Letters, Humanities, and Social Sciences, which was established in 1957. Twenty-one years later, the government divided the Council, making the Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council a separate entity to take over funding for research in the social sciences and humanities.

**B.** Using the name Canada Council for the Arts, or Canada Council, the organization provides funding for the arts in Canada: dance, media arts, music, theatre, visual arts, writing and publishing, and aboriginal arts. In addition, the Canada Council may provide funds to publishers, concert presenters, and theatres. Writers may apply for a grant to support themselves while they finish a novel; dancers and composers similarly may be awarded subsistence funds for a period of time devoted to the creation of new work. The Canada Council also awards several annual prizes to artists. Perhaps the most well-known are the Governor General's Literary Awards. Decisions about grants and prizes are made by juries comprised of artists and arts professionals from across the country, about 750 of whom serve on the Canada Council juries each year.

**C.** In 1986, the Canada Council established the Public Lending Right Commission (PLRC). Public Lending Right ensures that authors receive financial compensation when their books are borrowed through a public library system. The program is intended to offset the injustice of library patrons accessing books for free—that is, without a portion of equivalent purchase price going to the author. Close to $10 billion per year is now paid to about 17,000 Canadian writers. Although similar programs exist in over 30 other countries, the Canadian program is unique in that its focus is solely on Canadian authors.

**D.** The Canada Council also selectively collects contemporary Canadian art. Currently it has over 17,000 works of art by approximately 3,000 artists in its Art Bank. More than one-third of these paintings, prints, photographs, and sculptures are on exhibit in private and public spaces throughout Canada. The works can also be seen on the Canada Council Art Bank website and the Google Art Project website.

**E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.**

## Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

**Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.**

1. Decisions for Canada Council recipients are essentially democratic.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. Government support for the arts in Canada extends back several decades.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. Popular authors can enjoy a small income without relying on bookstore sales.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. The Canada Council provides grants for authors to market their books.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. The Canada Council partners with some other organizations in art displays.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. The Canada Council awards provide basic financial assistance during the creative period.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. In the mid-twentieth century, theatre in Canada was virtually non-existent.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Non-Canadian authors with books in Canadian libraries do not receive payment.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Artists who receive Canada Council grants exhibit their work in council-supported shows.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

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PART 4

## Read the following article from a website.

As Metro Vancouver continues to struggle through a prolonged drought, water reservoirs are so low that officials have banned all lawn watering. Formerly lush neighbourhoods are now brown wastelands, except where residents either illegally water their lawn (as westside gardening enthusiast Darius Smith admits to doing) or replace them with the increasingly popular synthetic ones.

Vancouver homeowner, Annette Basi, recently installed artificial grass on her property and, except for the steep price tag, couldn't be happier. "It's nylon, it's fake, but it rocks! It looks like the real deal, it's always green, and it's super low maintenance. It's totally eco-friendly. No sprinkling, no pesticides. Just a bit of vacuuming."

Across the border, homeowners in drought-ravaged California have begun installing artificial lawns as officials are now offering them cost rebates as a financial incentive for their installation. But in Vancouver, Nick Lorimer, a city engineer, recommends that a bylaw be passed requiring residents to purchase a permit before installing an artificial lawn or face a hefty fine. "This is already the case in Toronto, and rightly so. Artificial grass has many advantages, but the fibre it's made from isn't highly permeable. It doesn't drain rainwater efficiently, especially if it's plastic rather than nylon. With heavy rains, these lawns could contribute to flooding," states Lorimer. The other issue is front lawn encroachments. "On front yards, fake turf often encroaches on city-owned property, hampering street cleaning and snow removal," says Lorimer.

Ottawa resident Joanne Persky would prefer an outright ban on artificial lawns. "They disrupt the ecosystem," she argues. "Ground vegetation absorbs carbon dioxide and emits oxygen, which is essential for life. It also helps regulate atmospheric temperatures. Natural fibres breathe, synthetics don't. Also, grass is food, and soil is home to earthworms, insects, and other things birds eat. As for humans, we don't know, yet, if synthetic lawns are safe. Along with spray-on lawn dyes, artificial grass may prove carcinogenic," continues Persky.

The water-conscious alternative, says Persky, is neither artificial nor real grass. "What you need is diverse and hardy natural ground cover," she insists. "I've planted my whole yard with mosses, herbs, and perennial wildflowers. I never water it, and it's always thriving."

## Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. Nick Lorimer would most likely advise Annette Basi to _____

- ◯ drain the flood water from her property.
- ◯ have nylon grass in her backyard only.
- ◯ pay her fine for not having a lawn permit.
- ◯ replace her nylon grass with plastic grass.

2. California's water conservation incentives would most likely be supported by _____

- ◯ Annette Basi.
- ◯ Darius Smith.
- ◯ Joanne Persky.
- ◯ Nick Lorimer.

3. Joanne Persky's main point is that _____

- ◯ spray-on lawns may prove to be carcinogenic.
- ◯ artificial grass is detrimental to the environment.
- ◯ living ground cover regulates atmospheric heat.
- ◯ real lawns are habitat and food for living things.

4. Compared to Annette Basi, Joanne Persky is more _____

- ◯ casual.
- ◯ ironic
- ◯ upbeat.
- ◯ formal.

5. The best title for this article is: _____

- ◯ Brown is the New Green: Drought and Aesthetics.
- ◯ Dry Lawn or Nylon: Not a Cut and Dried Choice.
- ◯ Eco-Friendly Ground Cover: Just Say No to Grass.
- ◯ The New Synthetic Lawns: Plastic and Fantastic.

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PART 4

**The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.**

It's cloudless for the eighth consecutive week, and there's still no rain in the forecast, so right now Mr. Lorimer's remarks appear to be 6._____ . But, actually, I read this article with considerable interest. 7._____ , most of my neighbours have artificial lawns. Aesthetically, they're perfect, but I'm still not convinced that synthetic is the way to go. Considering that their natural counterparts never truly require pesticides either, Ms. Basi's implication that fake ground coverings 8._____ is frankly bogus. 9._____ , I have serious concerns about the incentives in California. As Ms. Persky implies, when massive expanses of land are 10._____ , the world will surely be hotter, not better.

6. ◯ rather ironic
   ◯ on the money
   ◯ underestimated
   ◯ well-founded

7. ◯ Much like in the state of California
   ◯ Despite the city of Ottawa's ban
   ◯ On account of Toronto's incentives
   ◯ Because of Vancouver's rebates

8. ◯ are more economical in the long run
   ◯ repel both weeds and insects
   ◯ contribute to sustaining the planet
   ◯ reduce exposure to carcinogens

9. ◯ In stark contrast to Mr. Smith
   ◯ Based on Ms. Basi's comments
   ◯ Not unlike Mr. Lorimer
   ◯ As referred to by Ms. Persky

10. ◯ turned into cities
    ◯ choked with moss
    ◯ sprayed with dye
    ◯ unable to breathe

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# Answer Key

| PART 1 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | It created several networks. |
| Question 2 | The internet is growing too quickly. |
| Question 3 | formal. |
| Question 4 | dissatisfied employees. |
| Question 5 | explained. |
| Question 6 | speak to their staff |
| Question 7 | monitoring our staff's internet use |
| Question 8 | is informed about how to respond |
| Question 9 | is essential in our business |
| Question 10 | creating personal risks for themselves |
| Question 11 | personal online activities are a problem |

| PART 2 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | for your bike contest |
| Question 2 | me biking with a friend |
| Question 3 | biking accessories |
| Question 4 | written response |
| Question 5 | print my name |
| Question 6 | to fulfill the contest requirements |
| Question 7 | to get a bike for his trip |
| Question 8 | He’s unlikely to win. |

| PART 3 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | B |
| Question 2 | A |
| Question 3 | C |
| Question 4 | E |
| Question 5 | D |
| Question 6 | B |
| Question 7 | A |
| Question 8 | C |
| Question 9 | E |

| PART 4 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | have nylon grass in her backyard only. |
| Question 2 | Annette Basi. |
| Question 3 | artificial grass is detrimental to the environment. |
| Question 4 | formal. |
| Question 5 | Dry Lawn or Nylon: Not a Cut and Dried Choice. |
| Question 6 | rather ironic |
| Question 7 | Much like in the state of California |
| Question 8 | contribute to sustaining the planet |
| Question 9 | Not unlike Mr. Lorimer |
| Question 10 | unable to breathe |

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